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**NEWS
LETTER**

COUNTRY REPORT ON
AGRICULTURAL SECTOR IN SOMALIA

JANUARY 2026

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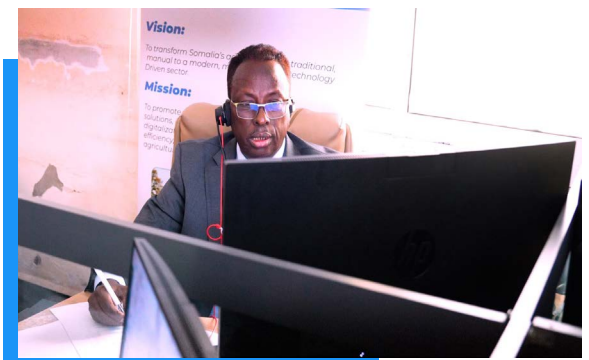


MINISTER OF AGRICULTURE INAUGURATE NEW CALL CENTER TO STRENGTHEN COMMUNICATION WITH SOMALI FARMERS

The Minister of Agriculture and Irrigation, **Hon. Mohamed Abdi Xayir (Maareeye)** today officially inaugurated a new Call Center Office added to the Ministry, the farming community will call the short number 507, which is designed to facilitate direct communication between the Ministry and Somali farmers.

This Call Center Office is the first office to be fully operational since the collapse, while previously the Ministry and farmers were contacted in an old way, which was and used **"Taar or Hello Hello"**.

This new service will enable farmers to contact the Ministry in a systematic and modern way, and receive information related to agricultural services, technical advice and warnings of agricultural diseases, the conditions of the country's rivers and any new developments in the Ministry's activities.





National Validation Workshop on the

Revision of the National Agricultural Mechanization Policy



The Department of Agricultural Technology and Innovation of the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation (MoAI) organized a National Validation Workshop on the revision of the National Agricultural Mechanization Policy, which was held in Mogadishu from 7 to 8 January 2026.

The workshop marked a critical milestone in the national policy formulation process, providing a structured platform for stakeholders to review the revised policy, validate its strategic direction, and build consensus prior to finalization and formal approval.



The workshop was officially opened by the Director General of the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation, **Eng. Mohamed Hassan Abdulle**, who underscored the pivotal role of agricultural mechanization in accelerating Somalia's agricultural transformation. He noted that reliance on traditional hand tools limits agricultural productivity, and emphasized the national objective to transition toward the use of modern agricultural machinery to improve efficiency and output.



He highlighted mechanization as a key driver for increasing productivity, addressing labor constraints, strengthening climate resilience, and enhancing competitiveness across agricultural value chains.

The Director General further affirmed the Ministry's commitment to lead the implementation of the National Agricultural Mechanization Policy, spearhead resource mobilization efforts, and work with government institutions and partners to support farmers' access to agricultural machinery and equipment as a cornerstone of sustainable agricultural development in Somalia.

The Director of the Department of Agricultural Technology and Innovation, **Eng. Dirie Abdi Mohamed**, highlighted the importance of the National Agricultural Mechanization Policy and explained why Somalia requires a dedicated and comprehensive mechanization policy at this stage of agricultural development.



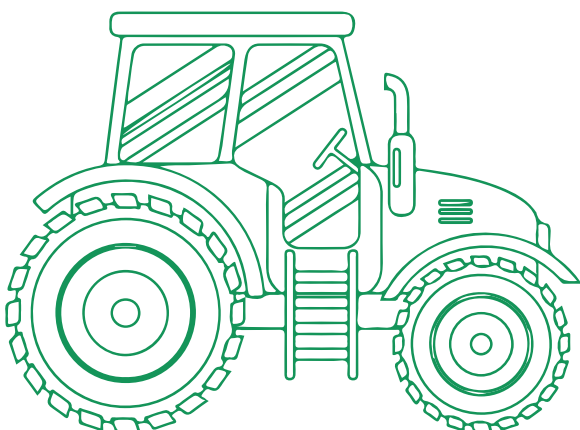
He emphasized that the revised policy is aligned with the National Transformation Plan (NTP) and is intended to address key structural constraints limiting agricultural productivity, resilience, and competitiveness. He further emphasized that the revised policy aims to establish a coherent, enabling framework that supports private sector-led, service-based, and sustainable mechanization development, while ensuring inclusivity for smallholder farmers and alignment with national development priorities.

The workshop brought together a broad and balanced group of participants, including senior officials from the Federal Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation, officials from Federal Member State Ministries of Agriculture, private sector actors, machinery dealers, farmer cooperatives and producer representatives, academic and research institutions, and development partners. This inclusive participation ensured that perspectives from across the agricultural mechanization value chain were reflected in the validation process.

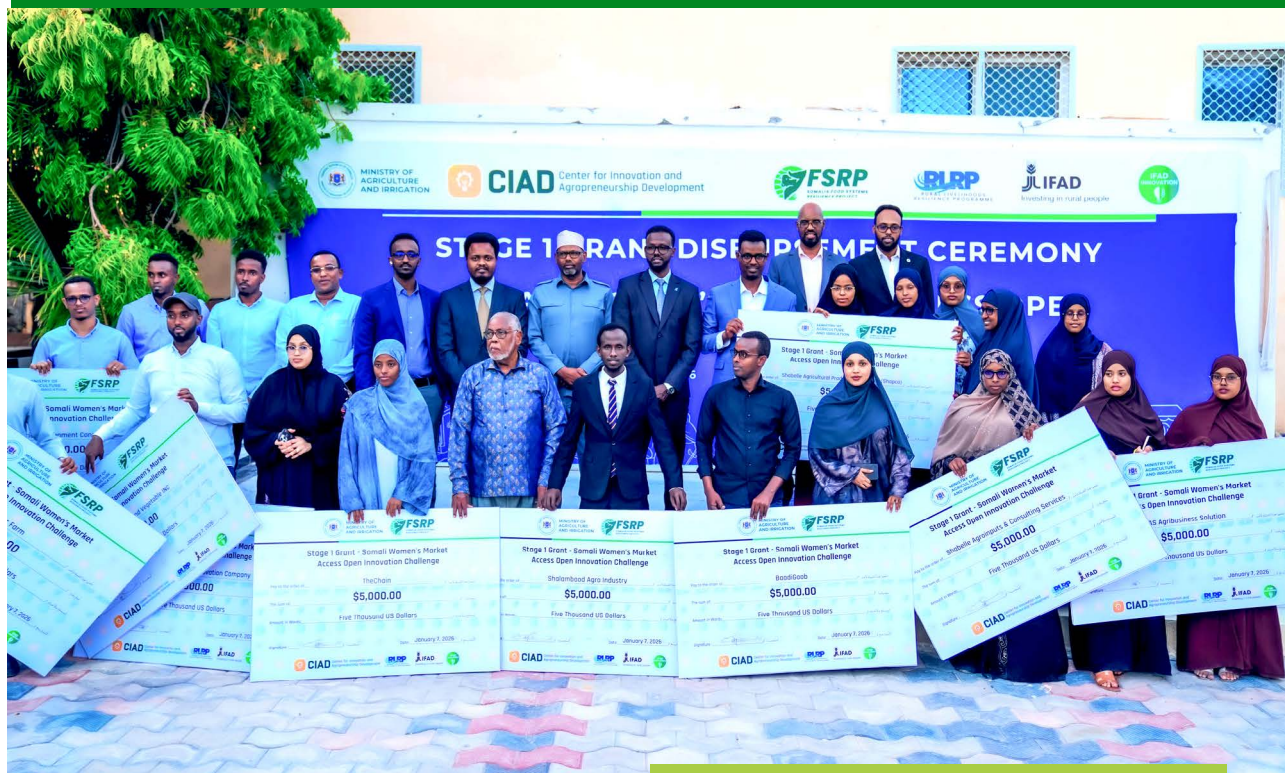


Participants engaged in structured group discussions and plenary sessions to review and validate the proposed policy interventions, strategic priorities, implementation modalities, and institutional arrangements.

The discussions generated constructive, evidence-based feedback and practical recommendations aimed at strengthening the coherence, feasibility, and responsiveness of the policy to regional and sector-specific needs. Key comments and recommendations were consolidated and incorporated to further refine and improve the final draft of the National Agricultural Mechanization Policy.



CELEBRATING INNOVATION IN SOMALI AGRIBUSINESS:



TEN COMPANIES AWARDED IN THE 2025 OPEN INNOVATION CHALLENGE

The Department of Agribusiness, Investment, and Cooperatives within the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation of the Federal Government of Somalia (FGS) has successfully organized a landmark ceremony to honor the achievements of ten pioneering companies. These enterprises emerged as winners of the 2025 Open Innovation Challenge for Market Access by Somali Farmers, a program designed to accelerate agricultural transformation through creativity, entrepreneurship, and inclusive growth.

The event marked the official recognition of these companies as they advanced into the first phase of the program, where they will pilot and implement their innovative solutions. Each company was awarded financial support, facilitated by the Department of Agribusiness, Investment, and Cooperatives in collaboration with the Center for Innovation and Agricultural Development (CIAD) of the Ministry. This funding is intended to strengthen their capacity to deliver practical solutions, enhance productivity, and generate employment opportunities across Somalia's agricultural sector.

A RIGOROUS SELECTION PROCESS

The ten companies were selected through a transparent and competitive process, ensuring that only the most impactful and scalable ideas were chosen. By receiving targeted financial support, each enterprise is now positioned to play a vital role in:

- Advancing agricultural production and value chains.
- Promoting agribusiness innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Creating new pathways for job creation and rural development.

PROGRAM IMPLEMENTATION AND SUPPORT



The Open Innovation Challenge is jointly implemented by CIAD and the Department of Agribusiness, Investment, and Cooperatives, with funded by FSRP food system resilience project and Rural Livelihoods Resilience Project (RLRP), the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD), and IFAD Innovation.



This partnership underscores the government's commitment to fostering collaboration between local enterprises and international development partners, ensuring that Somali farmers gain access to modern markets and sustainable opportunities.





AWARDED COMPANIES

The ten companies recognized for their outstanding contributions are:

- Baadi-Goob
- Badbaado AgroCrop Innovation Company
- Horn Afric Development Consultants
- Kobac Farm
- RAAS Agribusiness Solution
- Shabelle Agricultural Production Company (Shapco)
- Shabelle Agro-inputs and Consulting Services
- Shalambood Agro Business
- Somfresh Fruits and Vegetable INC
- The Chain

Each of these enterprises represents a unique vision for transforming Somalia's agricultural landscape, from modernizing input supply chains to enhancing fruit and vegetable production, and from consultancy services to innovative agribusiness solutions





January Field Activities on Ecosystem Restoration and Integrated Water Resources



During January 2026, the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation implemented field activities in Afgooye District focusing on ecosystem restoration, integrated water resources management (IWRM), and strengthening community capacity in sustainable agriculture. The activities were coordinated and supervised by Eng. Abdirahim Adan Abdi, Project Coordinator, as part of the Ministry's efforts to promote climate-resilient livelihoods and sustainable natural resource management.

Community awareness sessions were conducted on soil conservation, watershed protection, efficient use of water for agriculture, and the adoption of climate-smart farming practices. Under the guidance of Eng. Abdirahim Adan Abdi, farmers, water user groups, and local community members actively participated in the sessions, resulting in improved understanding of the relationship between environmental conservation, water availability, and agricultural productivity.

In addition, technical training and field-based support were provided to farmer groups through Farmer Field Schools and seed-saving initiatives.

The training focused on improved agronomic practices, climate-smart agriculture, seed selection, and local seed preservation. These activities strengthened farmers' practical skills, promoted peer-to-peer learning, and contributed to increased resilience and reduced dependence on external seed supply.

Implementation during the reporting period faced challenges related to climate variability, including irregular rainfall, drought conditions, limited access to agricultural inputs, and logistical constraints linked to infrastructure and security limitations. To mitigate these challenges, the project promoted climate-smart approaches, flexible implementation aligned with seasonal forecasts, and strengthened coordination with local authorities and community structures.

Overall, the January activities contributed positively to sustainable land and water management and improved the resilience of farming communities in Afgooye District. Planned actions for the following month include strengthening linkages between community-based and national early warning systems and continuing awareness initiatives on ecosystem restoration and integrated water resources management.



RESILIENCE STAKEHOLDERS' MEETING ON RESPONDING TO FOOD SECURITY CHALLENGES

Introduction

The Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation (MoAI) of the Federal Government of Somalia, through its Crop Production Department, participated in the Resilience Stakeholders' Meeting on Responding to Food Security Challenges, a high-level consultative forum aimed at strengthening national coordination on food security and resilience-building interventions.

The meeting was convened and led by the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation (MoAI-FGS) in collaboration with the Ministry of Planning, the Ministry of Livestock, the Ministry of Fisheries, and international partners including FAO, alongside key national and international stakeholders working on resilience, climate adaptation, and food security.

The discussions focused on strengthening the resilience of vulnerable communities, enhancing agricultural production systems, and mitigating the impacts of climate change on food availability and access. Particular emphasis was placed on integrated, multi-sectoral approaches and improved coordination among government institutions, development partners, and implementing stakeholders.



In parallel with the stakeholders' meeting, the Ministry officially launched its Call Center Office, marking the first fully operational agricultural call center established since the post-conflict period. Prior to this initiative, communication between the Ministry and farmers relied largely on informal and traditional methods, commonly known as **"Taar" or "Hello Hello"**, which limited structured information flow and service efficiency. The establishment of the Call Center represents a major milestone in modernizing farmer–government engagement and strengthening agricultural service delivery nationwide.



Objective of the Meeting

The engagement aimed to:

- Strengthen coordination among government institutions, development partners, and resilience stakeholders to address food security challenges in a sustainable and integrated manner.
- Promote climate-resilient agricultural production systems to improve food availability, access, and stability for vulnerable communities.
- Enhance communication mechanisms between the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation and farmers through the introduction of a modern, structured service platform.
- Improve farmers' access to timely information on agricultural services, technical advisory support, crop disease early warnings, national river conditions, and other sector updates.
- Reinforce the Ministry's commitment to implementing policies and programs aligned with national development frameworks and food security priorities



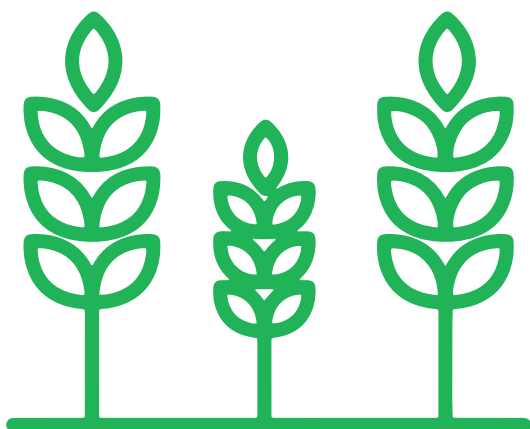


Key Discussions and Contributions



In his opening remarks, the Minister of Agriculture and Irrigation emphasized the importance of genuine collaboration among all stakeholders, noting that sustainable solutions to food insecurity require coordinated planning, shared responsibility, and long-term commitment across sectors. During the meeting, the Director of the Crop Production Department made a substantive contribution by highlighting the strategic role of crop production in building community resilience and national

food security. He underscored the need to strengthen productivity, climate-smart practices, and farmer support systems as core pillars of resilience programming. The Director reaffirmed the Ministry's strong commitment to implementing policies and programs aligned with national development frameworks, aimed at strengthening resilience, enhancing agricultural productivity, and ensuring sustainable food security across Somalia.

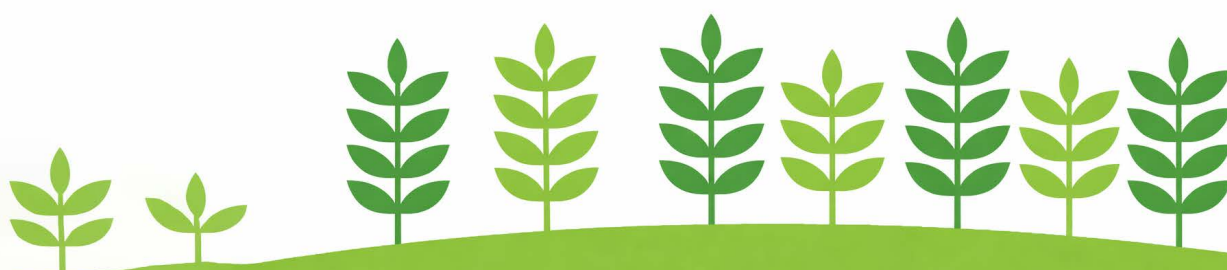


LAUNCH OF THE NATIONAL AGRICULTURAL EXTENSION STRATEGY & ACTION PLAN (2026–2030)



The Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation (MoAI) marked a major milestone for Somalia's agricultural sector with the official launch of the National Agricultural Extension Strategy & Action Plan (2026–2030).

The launch event, held on 19 January 2026 at the Villas Hotel in Mogadishu, brought together 50 key stakeholders from Federal Member States (FMS), development partners, research and academic institutions, the private sector, farmer organizations, and extension service providers. total of 50 participants from states and other stakeholders in agricultural sector.



Objectives of the Launch Event

The January launch ceremony aimed to:

- Officially introduce and socialize the National Agricultural Extension Strategy & Action Plan (2026–2030).
 - Present the Strategy's vision, objectives, and strategic pillars to key stakeholders.
 - Foster dialogue between MoAI, Federal Member States, and agricultural partners on implementation modalities.
- Collect initial stakeholder feedback to inform the rollout phase beginning in 2026.



Event Facilitation and Methodology

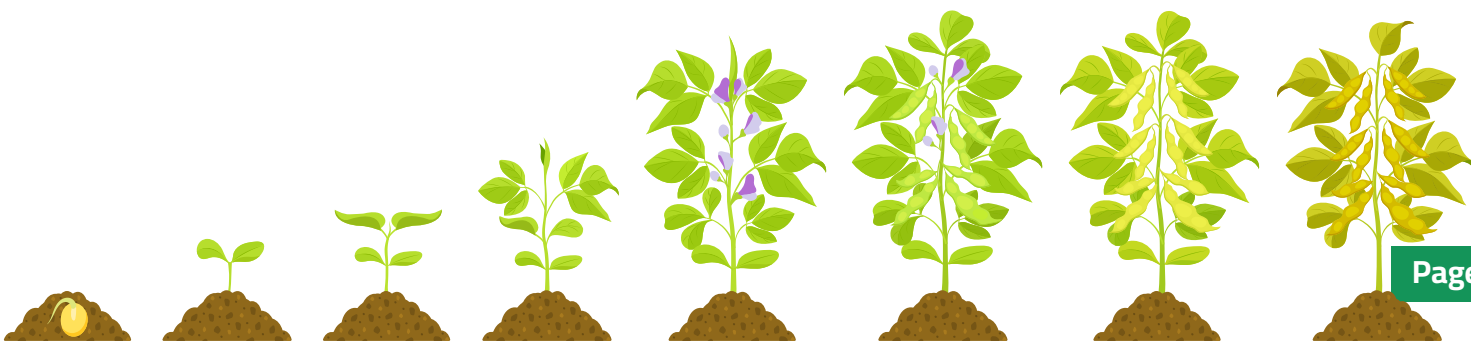
The event was led by the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation, with high-level leadership provided by the State Minister of MoAI, who delivered the opening address and highlighted the Strategy's relevance to national development and economic recovery.

Technical facilitation was provided by the Director of the Department of Research and Extension, who guided participants through the Strategy's core components.

The methodology combined:

- Policy-level presentations setting the national context.
- Visual and oral presentations detailing the Action Plan and its implementation framework.
- Interactive question-and-answer sessions to promote clarity, ownership, and stakeholder buy-in.

Participants engaged in discussions to identify immediate priorities and practical steps required to prepare for implementation at the start of 2026.



Key Recommendations

Moving Forward

Stakeholders have recommended a series of actions to bolster the effective implementation of the initiative. These include mobilizing financial resources and cultivating technical partnerships in advance of the 2026 rollout, decentralizing the Strategy by educating regional and state-level extension officers on the updated guidelines, investing in digital extension platforms to broaden outreach and enhance operational efficiency, incorporating gender-responsive and youth-inclusive methodologies into all extension activities, enhancing coordination among public, private, and NGO extension service providers, and establishing a dedicated task force within the Department of Research and Extension to monitor progress against first-year milestones.

Conclusion

The January 2026 launch of the National Agricultural Extension Strategy & Action Plan marked a decisive step toward strengthening Somalia's agricultural sovereignty and resilience. With broad stakeholder endorsement and strong leadership from the Ministry of Agriculture and Irrigation, the Strategy provides a clear and practical roadmap for improving farmers' access to knowledge, technologies, and innovation. As preparations move forward, effective collaboration among Federal Member States, development partners, private



sector actors, and farming communities will be essential. Successful implementation of the Strategy from 2026 to 2030 is expected to contribute significantly to increased agricultural productivity, enhanced climate resilience, improved food security, and sustainable economic growth in Somalia.



DESERT LOCUST SITUATION

The Desert Locust (DL) situation remained calm during January 2026. No surveys were conducted, however reports from district DL focal persons, scouts, and regional extension officers indicated that no locusts were seen in the coastal, sub-coastal, and inland areas of the locust breeding areas in the northwest and northeast regions. Light to moderate rains that fell during the beginning of the month in the breeding areas may create favorable ecological conditions. Vegetation is beginning to green, and the soil has become moist.

Forecasting

Ecological conditions in Somalia may become favorable for Desert Locust breeding in February 2026, particularly in northern coastal and sub-coastal areas such as Zaila, Lughaya, and Berbera districts. Light to moderate rains, influenced by the Deyr rainy season, are expected in the northwest and northeast regions, increasing soil moisture and vegetation growth, which could create suitable conditions for locust breeding.

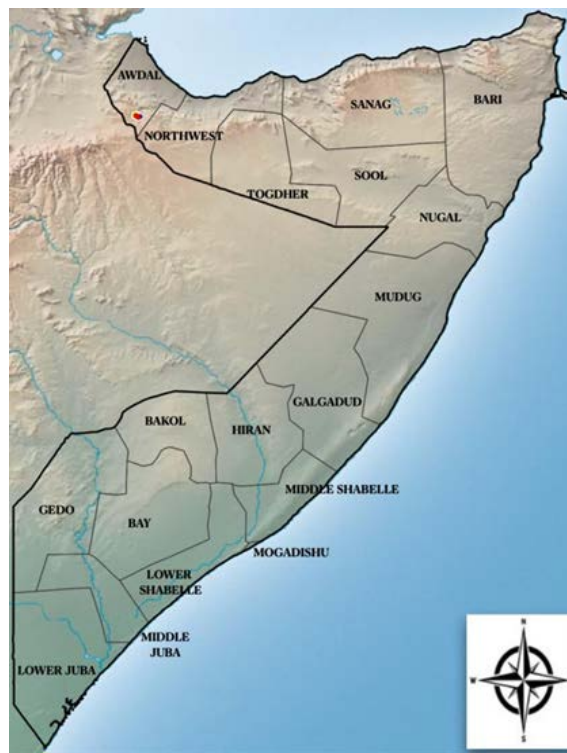


Figure 1: Desert Locust Situation during January 2026

Danger	Threat	Caution	Calm
			✓

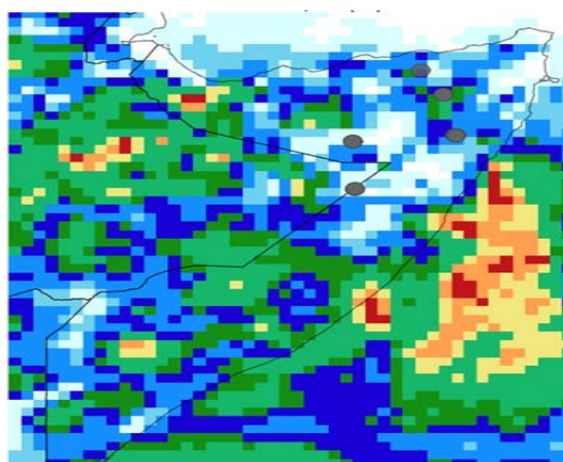


Figure 2: Rainfall Estimation January 2026



CALL CENTER OFFICE



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